

Join it

A marker joins two full ideas. Each idea has its own subject and verb.

idea 1**marker****idea 2**

because

WHY?

The truck stopped **because** the road was closed.
Because the road was closed, the truck stopped.

Razão. Antes de um nome: because of the closed road.

so

WHAT NEXT?

The road was closed, **so** the truck stopped.

Resultado. Sempre no meio, vírgula antes.

although

EVEN SO?

Although the road was closed, the truck arrived.
The truck arrived **although** the road was closed.

Contraste. Sem "but".

while

SIDE BY SIDE

The north road is open **while** the south road is closed.

Dois lados. Antes de um nome: during the storm.

ONE MARKER FOR EACH LINK · ERRORS TO AVOID

Because the plant is closed, ~~so~~ we wait. · say: Because the plant is closed, we wait.

Although it is late, ~~but~~ we ship. · say: Although it is late, we ship.

We stopped ~~because of~~ the road was closed. · say: because the road was closed.

I call him ~~during~~ he is driving. · say: while he is driving.

It failed, ~~then~~ we send another. · say: It failed, so we send another.

SPEAKING AND WRITING · A TENDENCY, NOT A LAW

Speaking: because · so (also opens a turn) · **though** at the end: "It is far. We go, though."

Writing: although · therefore · as a result · owing to

Counted in real text: "because" about 4× more in phone talk than in business news; "though" ends the sentence in half of the phone cases, none in the news.

Before a noun: **because of**, **during**. Before subject + verb: **because**, **while**.